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Census of Population Reference Guide

Structural Type of Dwelling and Collectives Reference Guide

2016

Census of Population, 2016

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. not available for any reference period
.. not available for a specific reference period
... not applicable
0 true zero or a value rounded to zero
0^s value rounded to 0 (zero) where there is a meaningful distinction between true zero and the value that was rounded
^{p} preliminary
^{r} revised
x suppressed to meet the confidentiality requirements of the *Statistics Act*
^{E} use with caution
F too unreliable to be published
* significantly different from reference category ($p < 0.05$)

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Structural Type of Dwelling and Collectives Reference Guide

Definitions and concepts

The census counts dwellings (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/dwelling-logements004-eng.cfm) for two main purposes. The first is to associate people with a spatial unit; otherwise, it would be difficult to ensure that a person is enumerated once and only once. The second objective is to publish counts of the dwellings themselves, along with information about dwelling characteristics.

The dwelling universe consists of collective dwellings (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/dwelling-logements002-eng.cfm) and private dwellings (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/dwelling-logements005-eng.cfm). The following classifications further describe private dwellings, as defined in the *Dictionary, Census of Population, 2016* (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/index-eng.cfm), Catalogue no. 98-301-X and have been created in accordance with the 2016 Census dwelling universe:

- regular dwelling (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/dwelling-logements011-eng.cfm)
- private dwelling occupied by usual residents (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/dwelling-logements006-eng.cfm)
- marginal dwelling occupied by usual residents (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/dwelling-logements009-eng.cfm)
- private dwelling occupied by foreign residents and/or by temporarily present persons (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/dwelling-logements010-eng.cfm)
- private dwelling, unoccupied (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/dwelling-logements015-eng.cfm).

Structural type of dwelling (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/dwelling-logements013-eng.cfm) refers to the structural characteristics and/or dwelling configuration. This dwelling characteristic variable is collected for all private dwellings in Canada and does not apply to collective dwellings.

A collective dwelling is a dwelling used for commercial, institutional or communal purposes. In standard census products, data on collective dwellings are available for collective dwellings with at least one usual resident.

Classifications

Structural type of dwelling

The variable for structural type of dwelling classifies private dwellings into the following nine mutually-exclusive categories: single-detached house, semi-detached house, row house, apartment or flat in a duplex, apartment in a building that has five or more storeys, apartment in a building that has fewer than five storeys, other single-attached house, mobile home and other movable dwelling. The *Census Dictionary* (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/index-eng.cfm) provides a definition for each structural type of dwelling.

Collective dwelling

The 2016 Census also collected information about collective dwelling type. Collective dwellings are organized into 10 broad categories: hospital, nursing home and/or residence for senior citizens, residential care facility, shelter, correction or custodial facility, lodging or rooming house, religious establishment, Hutterite colony, establishment with temporary accommodation services and other establishment. These categories have been established based on the services provided by the establishment and the type of residents. Data about the types, levels of services offered and the clientele are used to derive a more detailed classification of collective dwellings. The *Census Dictionary* (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/index-eng.cfm) provides a definition for every type of collective dwelling.

Collective dwellings can also be classified as institutions or non-institutions. This variant classification is used to create the institutional resident indicator which is used for some Census data products. The distinction between institutional and non-institutional collectives is described in the *Census Dictionary* (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/index-eng.cfm).

The disseminated data arranges collective dwelling types into categories of collective dwellings. These categories have been established based on considerations of data quality and historical comparability.

Questions

The data describing the structure of each dwelling, whether the dwelling is private or collective, are obtained directly from trained enumerators.

Structural type of dwelling

The Census of Population, 2016, questionnaires have no specific question that aim to collect information on the structure of each dwelling. Rather, structural type of dwelling is collected by trained enumerators. A picture representation of the structural type of dwelling, and its definition, is supplied to enumerators. This helps ensure consistency in the classification process across Canada. The following diagrams are some of the tools used to assign the structural type.

Single-detached house
(Code 1)

A single dwelling not attached to any other dwelling or structure (except its own garage or shed). A single-detached house has open space on all sides, and has no dwellings either above it or below it.

A mobile home fixed permanently to a foundation should be coded as a single-detached house. (See Code 8.)

Semi-detached House
(Code 2)

One of two dwellings attached side by side (or back to back) to each other, but not to any other dwelling or structure (except its own garage or shed). A semi-detached dwelling has no dwellings either above it or below it and the two units together has open space on all sides.

Row house
(Code 3)

One of three or more dwellings joined side by side (or occasionally side to back), such as a town house or garden home, but not having any other dwellings either above or below.

If row houses are attached to high-rise buildings, assign code 3 to each townhouse.

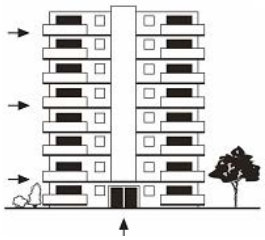
Apartment or flat in a duplex
(Code 4)

One of two dwellings located one above the other. If duplexes are attached to triplexes or other duplexes or to other non-residential structure (e.g. a store), assign code 4 to each apartment or flat in the duplexes.

Apartment in a building that has five or more storeys
(Code 5)

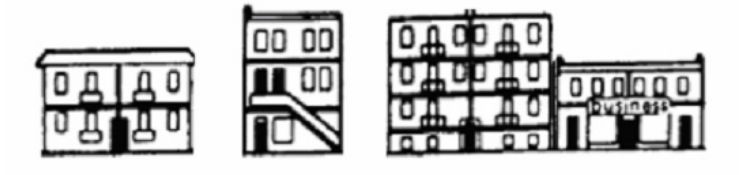
A dwelling unit in a high-rise apartment building which has five or more storeys.

Also included are apartments in a building that has five or more storeys where the first floor and/or second floor are commercial establishments.



Apartment in a building that has fewer than five storeys
(Code 6)

A dwelling unit attached to other dwelling units, commercial units, or other non-residential space in a building that has fewer than five storeys.



Other single-attached house
(Code 7)

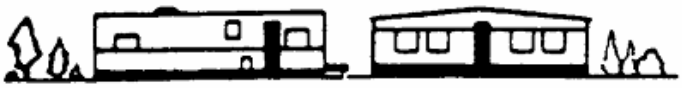
A single dwelling that is attached to another building and that does not fall into any of the other categories, such as a single dwelling attached to a non-residential structure (e.g., store or church) or occasionally to another residential structure (e.g., apartment building).

Mobile home
(Code 8)

A single dwelling designed and constructed to be transported on its own chassis and capable of being moved to a new location on short notice. It may be placed temporarily on a foundation such as blocks, posts or a prepared pad and may be covered by a skirt.

A mobile home must meet the following two conditions:

- It is designed and constructed to be transported on its base frame (or chassis) in one piece.
- The dwelling can be moved on short notice. This dwelling can be easily relocated to a new location, because of the nature of its construction, by disconnecting it from services, attaching it to a standard wheel assembly and moving it without resorting to significant renovations and reconstructions.



Other movable dwelling
(Code 9)

A single dwelling, other than a mobile home, used as a place of residence, but capable of being moved on short notice, such as a tent, recreational vehicle, travel trailer, houseboat, or floating home.

Collective dwelling

Collective dwellings are classified using data collected by census enumerators with the Collective Dwelling Record, Form 1A (http://www23.statcan.gc.ca/imdb/p3Instr.pl?Function=getInstrumentList&Item_Id=296898&UL=1V&). Each collective dwelling is enumerated using a unique Form 1A. This form is used in the enumeration of all collective dwellings and provides an overview of the collective dwelling, including the total number of usual residents and the type of collective being enumerated. In order to create the more detailed classification of collective dwellings, an administrator of each collective dwelling is asked a series of auxiliary questions regarding the level of services provided at the collective dwelling. Based on this information, the appropriate collective dwelling classification is assigned. See Figure 1.1.

Figure 1.1
Collective dwelling type code and auxiliary questions

Section II - Collective dwelling type code and auxiliary questions

Check one collective dwelling type and answer the questions in that section.

◯ **Hospital (10)**

A1) Is this facility licensed as a hospital?
- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

A2) What services are provided at this facility? (Mark one only.)
- ◯ Short-term care
- ◯ Long-term care
- ◯ Both short-term and long-term care

◯ **Nursing home and/or residence for senior citizens (20)**

B1) What levels of service are provided to residents at this facility? (Mark one only.)
- ◯ Extended health care services (professional health care monitoring, nursing care and supervision 24 hours a day). Residents are not independent in most activities of daily living.
- ◯ Support services or assisted living services (meals, housekeeping, laundry, supervision of medication, assistance bathing or dressing, etc.), but no extended health care services. Residents are independent in most activities of daily living.
- ◯ Extended health care services to some residents, but only support services or assisted living services to other residents. For example, a facility that is a mix of both a nursing home and a residence for senior citizens.

NOTE: If no care and service is provided to anyone, the facility should be enumerated as a private dwelling.

◯ **Residential care facility, such as a group home for persons with disabilities or addictions (30)**

C1) Is this facility for (mark all that apply):
- ◯ primarily children/minors
- ◯ persons with psychological disabilities
- ◯ persons with an addiction
- ◯ persons with physical challenges and/or disabilities
- ◯ persons that are developmentally delayed
- ◯ other – specify: _____

◯ **Shelter (40)**

D1) Is this facility primarily for (mark one only):
- ◯ homeless persons
- ◯ ex-inmates (in halfway houses)
- ◯ abused women and their children
- ◯ other – specify: _____

◯ **Correctional or custodial facility (50)**

E1) Is this facility primarily a (mark one only):
- ◯ federal correctional facility
- ◯ young offenders' facility
- ◯ provincial/territorial custodial facility
- ◯ jail/police lock-up facility

◯ **Lodging or rooming house (60)**

◯ **Religious establishment such as a convent, monastery or seminary (70)**

◯ **Hutterite colony (80)**

◯ **Establishment with temporary accommodation services such as a hotel, campground, YMCA, Ronald McDonald House or hostel (90)**

F1) Is this establishment a (mark one only):
- ◯ hotel, motel or tourist establishment
- ◯ campground or park
- ◯ other establishment with temporary accommodation services such as a YMCA/YWCA, Ronald McDonald House or hostel

◯ **Other establishment such as a school residence, military base, work camp or vessel (91)**

G1) Is this establishment a (mark one only):
- ◯ school residence or training centre residence
- ◯ military base
- ◯ commercial vessel
- ◯ work camp
- ◯ government vessel
- ◯ other

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Note: Information on the historical comparability of the Census of Population, 2016, questions with those asked in earlier censuses is provided in the 'Comparability' section of this document.

Data quality

The 2016 Census of Population underwent a thorough data quality assessment, similar to what was done for past censuses. A number of data quality indicators (briefly described below) were produced and used to evaluate the quality of the data.

The data quality assessment was done in addition to the regular quality checks completed at key stages of the census. For example, during data collection and processing, the consistency of the responses provided was checked and the non-response rates for each question were analysed. As well, the quality of imputed responses was assessed as part of the data editing and imputation steps. Finally, resulting census counts were compared with other data sources, and certified for final release.

For information about data quality for the census subdivision of Wood Buffalo, the data collection methodology and the use of administrative data sources, please refer to Appendix 1.4 (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/98-304/app-ann1-4-eng.cfm) of the Guide to the Census of Population, 2016, Catalogue no. 98-304-X.

The main highlights of this assessment for the data pertaining to the structural type of dwelling and collectives are presented below.

Data quality indicators

A number of quality indicators were produced and analysed during the data quality assessment of the Census of Population. Two of these are presented to users: the global non-response rate (GNR) and the imputation rate by question.

The GNR combines non-response at the household level (or total non-response) and non-response at the question level (partial non-response). It is calculated for each geographic area. The GNR is the key criterion that determines whether or not the census counts are released for a given geographic area – data are suppressed for geographic areas with a GNR equal to or greater than 50%. More information on the GNR is available in the *Guide to the Census of Population, 2016* (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/98-304/index-eng.cfm), Catalogue no. 98-304-X.

The imputation rate by question, excluding imputation for total non-response, is a quality measurement specific to each question in the census. It measures the proportion of respondents ("respondents" being defined as those for whom a fully or partially completed questionnaire was returned) who did not answer the question, or whose response was invalid and for which a valid value was assigned. Imputation eliminates gaps in the data and, when done appropriately, reduces bias introduced by non-response. This is done by identifying persons or households in the same geographical area that have characteristics similar to the incomplete record and by copying their values to fill in the missing or erroneous responses.

Certification of final counts

Once data processing, editing and imputation were completed, the data were tabulated to represent the total Canadian population. Certification of the final counts was the last step in the validation process leading to recommendation for release of the data for each geography and domain of interest. Based on the analysis of data quality indicators and the comparison of the census counts with other data sources, the recommendation is for unconditional release, conditional release or non-release for quality reasons. In the case of conditional release or non-release, appropriate notes and warnings are included in the products and provided to users. Several data sources were used to evaluate the census counts. However, since the risk of error often increases for lower levels of geography and for smaller populations, and the data sources used to evaluate these counts are less reliable (or not available) at these lower levels, it can be difficult to certify the counts at these levels.

Census counts are also subject to confidentiality rules that ensure non-disclosure of individual respondent identity and characteristics. For more information on census confidentiality rules, please refer to the *Guide to the Census of Population, 2016* (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/98-304/index-eng.cfm), Catalogue no. 98-304-X.

Comparability of concepts over time

Structural type of dwelling

The structural type of dwelling concept has remained relatively stable since the 1981 Census. Though there were no changes between the 2016 and 2011 censuses, there have been some adjustments to the concepts and classifications in earlier censuses. In 2011, additional information was added for classification within definitions for 'row house' and 'apartment in a building that has five or more storeys.' Starting in 2006, 'apartment or flat in a duplex' includes duplexes attached to other dwellings or buildings. Prior to the 2006 Census, duplexes attached to other dwellings or buildings were classified as an 'apartment in a building that has fewer than five storeys.' Starting in 1981, dwellings in apartment buildings are classified in two categories, 'apartment in a building that has five or more storeys' and 'apartment in a building that has fewer than five storeys.' Previously, this distinction between the heights of apartment buildings was not available and these types of dwellings were all classified as 'apartments.' Since there are more variants in the classification of structural type of dwelling prior to the 1981 Census, users are cautioned to use census reference materials when making historical comparisons that predate the 1981 Census.

Collective dwellings

For the 2016 Census of Population there are three changes to the existing classifications of collective dwelling types.

1) Nursing homes and residences for senior citizens were classified separately for the 2016 Census, as was done in 2011. However, an additional category was introduced for 2016 to classify facilities which offer both levels of services at these facilities. The description of the new category is 'Extended health care services to some residents, but only support services or assisted living services to other residents. For example, a facility that is a mix of both a nursing home and a residence for senior citizens.'
2) In 2011, residential care facilities were classified into one of three groups based on the main type of service provided at the facility. The 2016 collection method, however, allowed for multiple responses to the different types of services provided at these facilities. As a result, residential care facilities are now assigned the same collective dwelling type value and five additional flags indicate whether the facility provides one or more of the following services:
    - services primarily for children/minors
    - services for persons with psychological disabilities
    - services for persons with physical challenges and/or disabilities
    - services for persons that are developmentally delayed
    - services for persons with an addiction
3) The classification for hotels, motels and other establishments with temporary accommodations excludes bed and breakfasts for the 2016 Census of Population. Bed and Breakfasts, which are now a part of the private dwelling universe, were classified as collective dwellings in the 2011 and earlier censuses.

Comparability with other data sources

Structural type of dwelling

Some other surveys, including, but not limited to, the Labour Force Survey (LFS) and the Survey of Household Spending (SHS), collect structural type of dwelling data. In these cases, the data may be respondent-reported via questionnaire. These responses do not always have the same level of detail as is recorded by the trained enumerators during listing activities for the Census of Population. For this reason, users are advised to refer to the *Census Dictionary* (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/dict/index-eng.cfm) as well as any survey-specific metadata when comparing structural type of dwelling with other data sources.

Collective dwellings

Users should be cautioned that the census collective dwelling types are not expected to always agree with classifications used in administrative data or other sources. In the census, some collective dwellings are classified by the types and levels of services offered, rather than by their name or official status from a business or institutional perspective. Furthermore, census data are only collected for usual residents living in collective dwellings. Data for foreign residents and/or temporarily present persons are not collected in the census, while these residents may be included in other administrative data sources.

Data quality notes

Structural type of dwelling

The overall quality of the dwelling variables from the 2016 Census of Population is deemed acceptable. While considerable effort is made throughout the entire process to ensure a high standard of data quality, the resulting data are subject to a certain degree of inaccuracy. The evaluation process for the dwelling variable consisted of the following:

- evaluation of collection procedures
- examination of the total imputation rates for structural type of dwelling
- historical comparison with data from previous censuses
- comparison with other sources of data where applicable.

To assess the appropriateness of the 2016 Census of Population data for a user's needs, and to understand the risk involved in drawing conclusions from or making decisions on the basis of these data, users should be aware of the following data quality indicators for the dwelling variables.

For the 2016 Census, the information for structural type of dwelling was validated or updated for almost 38% of private dwellings during the listing and field operation activities leading up to Census Day. For the remaining 62% of dwellings, the dwelling structural type is based on Statistics Canada's dwelling register, which draws from administrative sources and prior listing and field operation activities. The rates of structural type of dwelling validation or updating for private dwellings by province and territory can be seen in Table 1 below.

Three percent (3.0%) of the records for the structural type of dwelling were blank or invalid after listing and field activities, and required imputation for the 2016 Census of Population. This is almost identical to the rate for the 2011 Census. Imputation rates by province and territory can be seen in Table 1 below.

Table 1
Total private dwellings, validated or updated during listing activities, imputation rates for Canada, Provinces and Territories, Census of Population, 2016

	Structural type of dwelling		
Geography	**Total**	**Percent validated or updated**	**Percent imputed**
Canada	**15,412,443**	37.8%	3.0%
Newfoundland and Labrador	265,739	70.8%	2.3%
Prince Edward Island	71,119	74.9%	2.0%
Nova Scotia	458,568	56.4%	2.1%
New Brunswick	359,721	42.6%	3.8%
Quebec	3,858,943	28.2%	3.1%
Ontario	5,598,391	30.6%	2.9%
Manitoba	539,748	47.7%	2.0%
Saskatchewan	495,582	61.3%	3.0%
Alberta	1,654,129	48.7%	3.1%
British Columbia	2,063,417	47.0%	3.3%
Yukon	17,987	74.1%	3.0%
Northwest Territories	17,666	100.0%	0.6%
Nunavut	11,433	100.0%	1.7%

Source: Statistics Canada, Census of Population, 2016.

Comparisons of structural type of dwelling data for Canada between the 2011 and 2016 censuses in Table 2 show small variations in the share of dwelling types: a decrease in the share for 'single-detached house' (-1.4 percentage points), an increase in the share for 'apartment in a building that has five or more storeys' (+0.6 percentage points), an increase in the share for 'row house' (+0.4 percentage points) and an increase in the share for 'apartment or flat in a duplex' (+0.3 percentage points).

Table 2
Distribution of private dwellings occupied by usual residents by structural type of dwelling for Canada, Census of Population, 2006, 2011 and 2016

Structural type of dwelling	2006	2011	2016	Difference between 2011 and 2006	Difference between 2016 and 2011
Total	**100.0%**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**	**...**	**...**
Single-detached house	55.3%	55.0%	53.6%	-0.2pp	-1.4pp
Apartment in a building that has five or more storeys	9.0%	9.3%	9.9%	0.3pp	0.6pp
Movable dwelling	1.3%	1.4%	1.3%	0.1pp	0.0pp
Other dwelling	34.5%	34.3%	35.2%	-0.1pp	0.8pp
Semi-detached house	4.8%	4.9%	5.0%	0.1pp	0.1pp
Row house	5.6%	5.9%	6.3%	0.4pp	0.4pp
Apartment or flat in a duplex	5.4%	5.3%	5.6%	-0.1pp	0.3pp
Apartment in a building that has fewer than five storeys	18.4%	18.0%	18.0%	-0.4pp	0.0pp
Other single-attached house	0.3%	0.3%	0.3%	-0.1pp	0.0pp

... not applicable
pp = percentage point
Sources: Statistics Canada, Census of Population, 2006, Catalogue no. 97-554-XCB2006031 (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/english/census06/shared/redirectproduct.cfm?ips=97-554-XWE2006031), Census of Population, 2011, Catalogue no. 98-313-XCB2011022 (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/global/URLRedirect.cfm?lang=E&ips=98-313-XCB2011022), Census of Population, 2016, Catalogue no. 98-400-X2016016 (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/global/URLRedirect.cfm?lang=E&ips=98-400-X2016016).

To facilitate comparisons of structural type of dwelling between the census and other data sets, some categories may need to be regrouped. When comparing census counts to the Labour Force Survey (LFS) estimates, Table 3, and Survey of Household Spending (SHS) estimates, Table 4, the three sources produce similar distributions of structural type of dwelling. The most notable difference is in single-detached house, however, similar to the differences between the distributions for the other classifications, this difference is relatively stable over time.

Table 3
Distribution of private dwellings occupied by usual residents by structural type of dwelling for Canada, LFS estimates May 2005, May 2010, May 2015, Census of Population 2006, 2011, 2016

Structural type of dwelling	2005 LFS	2006 Census	Difference between 2006 Census and 2005 LFS	2010 LFS	2011 Census	Difference between 2011 Census and 2010 LFS	2015 LFS	2016 Census	Difference between 2016 Census and 2015 LFS
Total	**100.0%**	**100.0%**	**...**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**	**...**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**	**...**
Single-detached house	58.4%	55.3%	-3.1pp	57.3%	55.0%	-2.2pp	55.9%	53.6%	-2.3pp
Apartment in a building that has five or more storeys	7.9%	9.0%	1.0pp	9.1%	9.3%	0.1pp	9.5%	9.9%	0.4pp
Movable dwelling	1.5%	1.3%	-0.2pp	1.6%	1.4%	-0.2pp	1.3%	1.3%	0.1pp
Semi-detached house	4.3%	4.8%	0.5pp	4.5%	4.9%	0.4pp	4.7%	5.0%	0.3pp
Row house	5.7%	5.6%	-0.2pp	6.1%	5.9%	-0.1pp	7.0%	6.3%	-0.6pp
Apartment or flat in a duplex	4.1%	5.4%	1.3pp	4.0%	5.3%	1.3pp	4.3%	5.6%	1.3pp
Apartment in a building that has fewer than five storeys	17.3%	18.4%	1.1pp	16.8%	18.0%	1.2pp	17.0%	18.0%	1.0pp
Other[1]	0.8%	0.3%	-0.5pp	0.6%	0.3%	-0.4pp	0.4%	0.3%	-0.1pp

... not applicable
pp = percentage point
1. Other classifies 'other single-attached house' for census data. For LFS data, the response 'Other-specify' may contain additional types of dwellings not covered by the census classification.
Sources: Statistics Canada, Labour Force Survey, 2005, 2010, 2016, Census of Population, 2006, 2011, 2016.

Table 4
Distribution of private dwellings occupied by usual residents by structural type of dwelling for Canada, SHS estimates 2005, 2010, 2015 and Census of Population, 2006, 2011, 2016

Structural type of dwelling	2005 SHS	2006 Census	Difference between Census 2006 and SHS 2005	2010 SHS	2011 Census	Difference between 2011 Census and 2010 SHS	2015 SHS	2016 Census	Difference between 2016 Census and 2015 SHS
Total	**100.0%**	**100.0%**	**...**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**	**...**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**	**...**
Single-detached	56.9%	55.3%	-1.7pp	56.4%	55.0%	-1.4pp	54.0%	53.6%	-0.4pp
Single-attached[1]	10.1%	10.6%	0.6pp	11.6%	11.0%	-0.5pp	13.0%	11.6%	-1.5pp
Apartment[2]	31.1%	32.8%	1.8pp	30.3%	32.6%	2.3pp	31.9%	33.5%	1.6pp
Other[3]	1.9%	1.3%	-0.6pp	1.8%	1.4%	-0.4pp	1.1%	1.3%	0.2pp

... not applicable
pp = perrcentage point
1. Single attached includes the following census structural type of dwelling classifications: ‘semi-detached,’ ‘row house,’ ‘other single-attached.’
2. Apartment includes the following census structural type of dwelling classifications: ‘apartment or flat in a duplex,’ ‘apartment in a building with five or more storeys,’ ‘apartment in a building with fewer than five storeys.’
3. Other includes the following census structural type of dwelling classifications: ‘mobile home,’ ‘other movable dwellings.’
Sources: Statistics Canada, Survey of Household Spending, 2005, 2010, 2016, Census of Population, 2006, 2011, 2016.

Collective dwellings

Different treatment of how individual buildings of a collective are counted (i.e., counted as separate collectives or just one collective) results in trends that might give false impressions of growth or decline in specific categories. The counts of collective dwellings for some categories may reflect the count of individual buildings rather than business or institutional entities.

Difficulties in distinguishing between similar collective types may also have impacts on the counts from one census to another.

The 2016 Census measured the living arrangements of persons in seniors’ residence and nursing home collective dwellings. People were classified as living alone in their unit, living as a couple in their unit or living with others in their unit. In some seniors’ residence and nursing home collective dwellings, however, incomplete information from administrative records or questionnaires, as well as scanning errors during processing, resulted in at least 5% of persons being systematically classified as living alone in their unit regardless of their true living arrangements.

For the 2016 Census, 5.5% of collective dwelling records had blank or invalid information after field activities and, as a result, required imputation to derive the detailed collective dwelling classification. This was done in processing using the responses recorded in Section II of the Form 1A (Figure 1.1). In 2011, the detailed collective dwelling classification was assigned during field activities using a different collection tool (2011 Collective dwelling profile - PR-1) and no collective dwelling records required imputation. Imputation rates by type of collective dwelling can be seen below in table 5.

Table 5
Total collective dwellings imputation rates for Canada, Census of Population, 2016

	2016 Census	
Type of collective dwelling	**Total**	**Imputation rate**
Total – collective dwellings	**43,485**	5.5%
Hospitals	900	4.9%
Nursing homes and residences for senior citizens	6,330	5.0%
Residential care facilities	9,015	4.1%
Shelters	1,195	5.5%
Correctional and custodial facilities	815	5.2%
Lodging and rooming houses	2,150	...
Religious establishments	1,160	...
Hutterite colonies	375	...
Establishments with temporary accommodation services	17,495	6.8%
Other establishments	4,060	8.6%

... not applicable
Source: Statistics Canada, Census of Population, 2016.

Additional information

For additional information on structural type of dwelling and collective dwellings, please refer to the Topics (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/rt-td/index-eng.cfm) page. Additional information about data quality and universes can be found in the *Guide to the Census of Population, 2016* (http://www12.statcan.gc.ca/census-recensement/2016/ref/98-304/index-eng.cfm), Catalogue no. 98-304-X.